05-05 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Lost Key on the Garden Wall

① Last Sunday afternoon, my mother asked me to walk our neighbour Mrs. Li's small garden while she went to the hospital to see a friend. Mrs. Li, who is seventy-two, has a tiny back garden full of tomato plants and roses. She handed me a silver key on a **red string** and said, "Please lock the back gate when you leave. And please don't lose this key — it's the only one."

② The garden was warm and quiet. I watered the plants, pulled a few small weeds, and even picked up a thin yellow leaf that a wind had blown in. I felt proud, like a small gardener. At 4 p.m., I closed the back gate and turned the key carefully. Then I put the red string over my neck, patted my chest, and walked home.

③ Halfway down the street, I stopped like a stone. My neck felt light — too light. The red string was gone. **My heart jumped into my throat.** I ran back to the gate, searching the ground, the grass, and even the inside of my shoes. Nothing. The sky was getting grey. I imagined Mrs. Li coming home at night, standing outside her gate, unable to get in.

④ For a few minutes I felt like crying. Then I told myself, "Crying does not find keys." I started walking backwards along my path, eyes on every stone and every corner. At the small garden wall near the park, I saw a tiny flash of red in a crack between two bricks. It was the string, caught on a rough piece of stone! I had leaned against the wall ten minutes earlier to tie my shoes.

⑤ I pulled the string out slowly — and the key was still there. I almost shouted with joy. When I returned to Mrs. Li's flat that evening, I told her the whole story, including the losing part. She laughed, patted my shoulder, and said, "A key on a wall is nothing. A boy who comes back to find it — that is a real gardener." She gave me a warm tomato from her shelf and taught me how to make the string tighter.

⑥ That night, before sleep, I tied the red string into a small **knot** around the key and placed it back in Mrs. Li's hand. I learned two things in one afternoon: first, a small piece of string can carry a very large responsibility; and second, honesty is much lighter to carry than a lost key.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why did the writer visit Mrs. Li's garden?

A. To meet his own friends.
B. To water the plants while Mrs. Li was away.
C. To buy tomatoes for dinner.
D. To play football with other children.

2. What happened halfway down the street?

A. The writer saw a thief.
B. The writer realised the key and string were gone from his neck.
C. Mrs. Li called him by phone.
D. It began to snow.

3. Where did the writer finally find the red string?

A. Inside his shoe.
B. In a tomato plant.
C. In a crack between two bricks on a garden wall.
D. At the hospital.

4. How did Mrs. Li react when she heard the whole story?

A. She was angry and shouted at him.
B. She laughed and said he was a real gardener.
C. She asked him to pay for the key.
D. She refused to see him again.

5. What is the main lesson the writer learned?

A. Gardening is very easy.
B. Honesty and careful responsibility matter more than the key itself.
C. Keys should never leave their locks.
D. Tomatoes can open any gate.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段第1–2句 "my mother asked me to walk our neighbour Mrs. Li's small garden..."
【解析】原文说作者替邻居照看小菜园。A 见朋友、C 买西红柿、D 踢球均与原文不符。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B

【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段第2–3句 "My neck felt light... The red string was gone."
【解析】走到半路发现钥匙和红绳不在脖子上。A 小偷、C 接电话、D 下雪均无依据。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段末句 "in a crack between two bricks"
【解析】红绳卡在园墙两块砖的缝隙里。A/B/D 与原文不符。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段第3句 "She laughed, patted my shoulder, and said, 'A key on a wall is nothing. A boy who comes back to find it — that is a real gardener.'"
【解析】Mrs. Li 笑着称赞他是真正的园丁。A 生气、C 要求赔钱、D 不再相见都与原文相反。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨归纳题
【定位】第⑥段末句 "honesty is much lighter to carry than a lost key"
【解析】文末表明作者领悟到责任与诚实的意义。A 说园艺很容易、C 钥匙不能离锁、D 番茄万能都属无稽。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **weed** [n.] 杂草
- **crack** [n.] 缝隙
- **knot** [n.] 结